This morning it came out: in 2016, Avigdor Lieberman, then defense minister, informed Netanyahu that Hamas was preparing an operation inside Israel that included the taking of hostages. The document was apparently extremely detailed, and Lieberman and the army command also prepared a detailed plan for preventive action. The cabinet shrugged it off. The general complacency was based on Netanyahu's belief that Hamas was interested only in improving the material conditions in the Gaza Strip, nothing else.

Great news! A female Israeli soldier, Ori Megidish, a hostage apparently held alone, was found and liberated by the advancing troops. She is back in Israel.

Turkey's president, Recep Tayiip Erdoğan, attacks Israel in daily salvos. During one of his pro-Palestinian rallies, he promised to denounce Israel as a "war criminal." Coming from the Turkish president, this is quite a threat. Israel recalled its ambassador and will reconsider its relations with Turkey.

Harvard's president, Claudine Gay, announced the establishment of an advisory group to help eradicate antisemitism on campus. It took President Gay some time; let us hope that these aren't mere words.

A friend wrote to me from Paris: "Numerous swastikas drawn on the streets. French public opinion is desperately fractured." In France, the supporters of Israel nowadays are the extreme right (Marine Le Pen), as at the time of the Algerian War. Yesterday's antisemites are temporarily pro-Israel out of hatred against immigrants, as they were then, out of hatred against Algerians.

Tuesday, October 31

The Israeli ground offensive is progressing, deep in the enclave. No concrete information about military developments, except that from the moves reported by foreign correspondents, one may gather that the army aims to isolate Gaza City by cutting the north-south highway.